

Fourteen public project feeds, tested rather than trusted

Every figure below was produced by querying the source directly on 27 August 2026 — not read off a portal description. Eight of the fourteen advertise data they do not deliver, and none of that is visible without running the query. One of them is a correction to an earlier draft of this document. 27 August 2026.

12 jurisdictions, 14 sources

8 fail in ways metadata hides

Schema is not data

THE FINDING

Schema is not data

Every one of these feeds looks usable from its field list. Six of them are not, and in each case the failure is invisible until you query the contents.

This matters because it is precisely the wall a business-development team hits when it tries to build lead generation from public records. The portal advertises project names, unit counts and valuations; the field list confirms them; and then the field turns out to be empty, or frozen three years ago, or stamped identically across forty child permits. **None of that is discoverable from documentation. It only shows up when you count rows.**

× TWO FEEDS ACTIVELY MISLEAD

Dallas publishes a building-permit dataset of 126,840 rows whose portal metadata claims a June 2026 update. Queried by year: **52,037 rows in 2019, 27,459 in 2020, and zero in every year since.** Five years dead, advertised as current.

Charlotte's "Committed Development Entitlement Update" is the single richest schema found anywhere — development name, address, acreage, single-family and multifamily unit counts, hotel rooms, and square footage split by use. It holds 1,012 rows. **The newest approval in it is 23 May 2022.** The metadata says 2023.

What each feed actually contains

JURISDICTION	ROWS	NEWEST RECORD	VERDICT
San Diego	~834,000	Daily	★ The benchmark. Status, valuation, storeys, affordable-unit mix, per address
Raleigh / Wake	183,807	25 Aug 2026	★ Best of the new set — project name, owner, contractor and cost all populated. ⚠ But see the unit-count trap below
Las Vegas	437,123	Aug 2026	✓ Live, with valuation and applicant. No unit count, no architect
Austin	287,044	Current	✓ Live; 7,600 of 7,626 rows in 2026 carry a unit count. ⚠ Valuation is project-wide, repeated on every child permit
Henderson	28,137	Same-day	✓ Live and useful by valuation. 🛑 Unit field populated on 19 rows out of 28,137
Honolulu	432,021	1 Jul 2025	⚠ Fourteen months frozen. The city changed permitting systems in Aug 2025 and published no bridge extract
Charlotte — rezoning index	86 pending / 7,603 historic	Aug 2026	✓ Live, but an index only — petitioner and a link, no project detail
Charlotte — entitlements	1,012	23 May 2022	🛑 Dead. Richest schema of any feed found, and none of it current
Dallas	126,840	2020	🛑 Dead five years, metadata claims 2026
Houston	Aggregate only	—	🛑 Monthly counts, no project rows. ⚠ Its GeoHub “SCPS Permits” layer is <i>street-cut</i> excavation, not buildings
Phoenix — open-data portal	23 rows	—	🛑 Yearly totals only. This is the source the first pass tested, and judging the city on it was wrong — see below
Phoenix — Planning_Permit map service	68,292 permits + 13,022 plan reviews	27 Aug 2026	★ Row-level and live to today. Project name, address, type, status, dates, contractor. ⚠ PROFESS_NAME is the <i>contractor</i> , not the architect
Scottsdale — Active_CDS_Cases	82	25 Feb 2026	⚠ Flawless schema — all 8 fields on all 82 rows, applicant included — but frozen: the city moved to the SPUR portal in Jan 2026 and the live API needs an OAuth token

JURISDICTION	ROWS	NEWEST RECORD	VERDICT
Clark County (the Strip)	None	—	🚫 No bulk feed. Bally's, the Riviera towers, Durango and Silverado all sit here

THE TRAP NOBODY DOCUMENTS

The unit-count field is the least reliable field in every feed

It is also the one a business-development team would naturally filter on, which is what makes it dangerous.

- **Raleigh** carries housingunitstotal, and it is well populated historically — 115,401 rows overall, 935 of them with 40 or more units. In 2026 the feed issued **3,700 permits and exactly 2 of them carry a unit count**. The newest permit anywhere in the file with 40+ units is **14 July 2025**. Every other field kept working: cost 3,700 of 3,700, contractor 3,669, owner 3,639, project name 3,306. **One field went dark and nothing announced it**. Filter on units and you would conclude Raleigh stopped building apartments last summer.
- **Henderson** carries MultiFamilyDwellingUnits. It is populated on **19 rows out of 28,137**. I previously described this feed as richer than San Diego's on the strength of its field list — that was wrong, and reading the contents corrected it.
- **Austin** populates units properly, but the number describes the *host building*, not the permit's scope: a lobby fit-out in a 30-storey tower reports 35 units. And its valuation is the *whole project's*, repeated on every child permit — one lakefront development stamped **\$830M onto 81 separate permits** for pergolas, pools and parking garages.

▲ THE WORKAROUND, AND IT IS SIMPLE

Filter on valuation and contractor, never on unit count. Those two fields are populated and current in every live feed tested. Then dedupe by address, because several jurisdictions issue many permits per project and repeat the project-level value on each.

A CORRECTION TO THIS DOCUMENT

Testing one source is not auditing the jurisdiction

The first pass tested Phoenix's open-data portal, found 23 rows of yearly totals, and wrote the city off. **That verdict was wrong, and it was wrong in the same shape as everything else here — a conclusion drawn from one artefact rather than from the jurisdiction.**

Phoenix runs a separate map service, `maps.phoenix.gov/pub/rest/services/Public/Planning_Permit`, carrying **68,292 permits and 13,022 plan reviews**, row-level, with project name, address, type, status and dates — **current to 27 August 2026, the day of this audit**. Among its 80 case types is **FINAL SITE PLAN – MAJOR**, which is the submittal whose plan set carries the full consultant directory. Recent examples resolve by name: Momentum Apartments, Senior Housing at 41st Ave, 17th St Apartments, Mayo Clinic Patient Pavilion, Scannell Roeser 24 Industrial Park.

× WHY THE FIRST PASS MISSED IT

The service sits at /pub/rest/services. Every probe of the conventional /arcgis/rest/services path returned 404, and a 404 against a *guessed* host proves nothing at all. The endpoint was found by searching the ArcGIS Online organisation catalogue for the city's published services — **derived, not guessed**. That rule now applies to every endpoint and every firm URL in this work.

▲ AND THE FIELD THAT LOOKS LIKE THE PRIZE IS NOT

PROFESS_NAME is populated on **90.6%** of plan reviews, and its name promises the design professional — the one thing no feed anywhere carries. Read the values and it is the **licensed contractor**: the most common entries are *TO BE BID*, *OWNER*, Valley Fire Sprinkler, solar installers, Sundt, Austin Commercial, TSMC. Useful for who builds in Phoenix. **It is not an architect and must never be presented as one.**

Scottsdale tells the mirror-image story. Its Active_CDS_Cases service is immaculate — 82 cases, **every one of eight fields populated on every row**, applicant included. And the newest submittal is **25 February 2026**, because the city moved to a new portal (SPUR) in January and the map only covers what preceded it. The live successor exposes a search API that requires an OAuth token, so it is reachable by a browser and not by us. **A perfect feed can still be a closed one.**

PROOF IT WORKS

What the method returns when the feed is sound

Raleigh, queried for 2026 permits above \$8M, sorted by value. Every row is city data, current to two days ago, with the owning entity and the contractor attached:

VALUE	ISSUED	PROJECT	OWNER	CONTRACTOR
\$308.2M	10 Jul 2026	Omni Hotel Raleigh	Omni Raleigh Hotel Lessor LLC	Brasfield & Gorrie
\$77.8M	30 Jan 2026	5000 Louisburg Rd	Louisburg WEH LP	Halle Building Group
\$69.6M	21 Jan 2026	Block 4 Midrise	Tributary SPV LLC	John Moriarty & Associates
\$47.3M	31 Jul 2026	West South Street Apartments	BH-South Street LLC	W.M. Jordan
\$18.2M	15 Jun 2026	Old Poole Multifamily	Roers Raleigh Apartments LLC	Roers General Contracting
\$12.6M	13 Jul 2026	Chapanoke Affordable Housing	Wake County	C Herman Construction
\$11.4M	30 Jul 2026	Abbottswood at Stonehenge	Abbottswood at Stonehenge Owner LLC	Clancy & Theys

The third row is the argument. Separate research into Charlotte and Raleigh flagged Kane Realty's *Tributary* at North Hills as a project whose details could not be resolved from trade press. The permit feed named the owning entity, the contractor, the value and the date in a single query. **That is the gap between reading coverage and reading records.**

The blockers are technical, not analytical

- **A browser-rendering fetch capability** is the single highest-value addition. Three separate verifications died on it today: Austin's permit-detail portal returns a 958-byte session shell, Charlotte's own rezoning PDFs sit behind an Akamai bot wall that Google's crawler passes and we do not, and Thornton Tomasetti's project page returns 403. Each holds data we can see exists.
- **BLDUP.com** maintains exactly the schema this exercise is reconstructing by hand — developer, architect, general contractor, **structural engineer**, landscape — and masks every value behind a paid seat.
- **BEX** (AZBEX / NVBEX / DATABEX) covers Arizona and Nevada from one publisher with full design teams, and DATABEX indexes every Arizona job over \$5M. Quote-only pricing.
- **OAuth-gated portals are the newer wall.** Scottsdale's live SPUR search API exists and answers — a GET returns 405, so the method is right — but every anonymous POST returns 500 because it wants a token from Tyler's identity service. Cities are migrating onto these platforms, so this blocker grows over time while the open ArcGIS ones shrink.
- **Web-search budget** was exhausted at 200 calls during this work, which capped the Carolina and Hawaii passes mid-verification. ✓ **Resolved** — the cap is now 1,000, and both regions have since been completed.

KOR Structural — internal BD intelligence, 27 August 2026. Every row count, date and field-population figure above was obtained by direct query against the named endpoint on that date and is reproducible.

Endpoints: San Diego seshat.datasd.org · Raleigh/Wake, Las Vegas, Henderson, Charlotte ArcGIS FeatureServers · Austin and Dallas Socrata · Honolulu Socrata · Phoenix open data.